

WHITE PAPER · GOVERNANCE PAPER

Audit Evidence Ledger for AI-Assisted Accounting Workflows

Traceability, event records, review states and evidence exports, and how audit teams can reconstruct what supported an AI-assisted answer.

● Audit

● Assurance

FORMAT

PDF · Enterprise access

READING TIME

About 15 minutes

EDITION

Q4 2026

Educational research only. This paper does not constitute accounting, tax, legal, audit or compliance advice.

ABOUT THIS PAPER

Read this first.

This paper is for the people who will have to explain AI-assisted work to an auditor, a regulator or a client. It describes what an evidence record should contain, how review states and exports should work, and what to ask of any system that claims to support audit. It is vendor-neutral by design, so you can use it to evaluate any approach, including ours. It is an Enterprise Access paper.

WHO IT IS FOR	Audit and assurance leaders, internal audit and risk teams, controllers and AI governance owners who must be able to explain, after the fact, how an AI-assisted answer came to be.
THE QUESTION	How can audit teams reconstruct what supported an AI-assisted answer?
THE THESIS	An evidence ledger is a durable, structured record of how an AI-assisted answer came to be (the question, the sources and versions, the handling, the review states and the outcome) designed so that a third party can reconstruct it later.
THE EVIDENCE GATE	Can an independent reviewer reconstruct, from the record alone, what was asked, what was relied on, what was answered, who reviewed it and what they decided?
THE NEXT STEP	Test evidence readiness against your own audit needs, or request a governance-focused enterprise briefing.
EDITION	Q4 2026. About 15 minutes to read. Enterprise Access: access is approved on request.

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SUMMARY

Executive summary

An AI-assisted answer is only as defensible as the record behind it. If the question, the sources, the handling and the review cannot be reconstructed later, the answer cannot be defended, however good it was.

Chat histories are not evidence. They are conversations: editable, incomplete and detached from sources, versions and decisions. An audit team needs something different, a structured record that shows how an answer was produced and what a person did with it, in a form that can be sampled, tested and exported.

This paper describes such a record, which we call an evidence ledger. It covers the events worth capturing, the review states they move through, the properties that make a record trustworthy, what an export must contain for audit use, and how audit teams can use the whole thing to test controls over AI-assisted work.

Five tests of audit readiness

#	TEST	THE QUESTION TO PUT TO ANY VENDOR
1	Completeness	Does every AI-assisted answer produce a record, including those that were escalated or rejected?
2	Provenance	Does the record identify the sources relied on, with versions and effective dates?
3	Review states	Does it show who reviewed, what they decided and when, and keep earlier states?
4	Integrity	Can the record be altered without leaving a trace, and who can see it?
5	Exportability	Can an auditor export a defined population with completeness indicators?

THE SHORT VERSION

A ledger is not a log of everything. It is the smallest record that lets a stranger reconstruct a decision, and trust that the record has not been quietly changed.

What to do with this paper. Use Section 2 to define your evidence record, Section 5 to specify exports, and Section 8 as a checklist for any vendor. If you want to test these ideas against ZoikoLogia™ with Kriton™ specifically, the last section explains how.

SECTION 1

Why reconstructability matters

If you cannot reconstruct how an answer was produced, you cannot defend it.

Audit and assurance work rests on evidence that is relevant, reliable and complete enough to support a conclusion. When AI assists in producing an answer that later feeds a deliverable, an auditor’s questions are familiar: what was the basis, who looked at it, and how do we know?

The difficulty is that a conversational interface is a poor evidence source. It is built to help, not to preserve. The comparison below shows the gap.

A CHAT TRANSCRIPT	AN EVIDENCE RECORD
Records what was said	Records what happened: events, in order
Sources may be named loosely, or not at all	Sources identified, with version and effective date
Cannot show the handling applied	Shows risk handling: answered, caveated or escalated
Rarely shows who reviewed or decided	Shows reviewer, decision and time
Can often be edited or deleted	Designed so changes leave a trace
Hard to sample or export	Structured, filterable and exportable

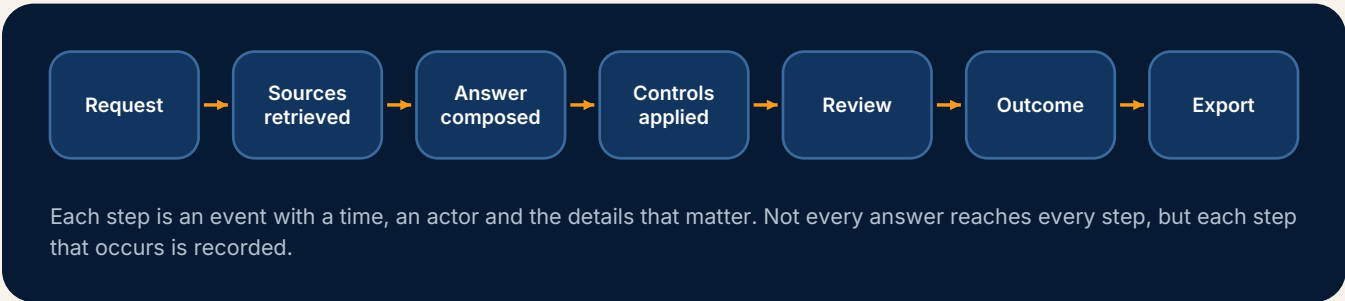
A USEFUL REFRAME

Stop asking “can we see the chat?” and start asking “could a stranger reconstruct this decision from the record alone?”.

SECTION 2

Anatomy of an evidence record

A record is a sequence of events, each capturing one thing that happened.



EVENT	WHAT IS CAPTURED	WHY AN AUDITOR WANTS IT
Request	Who asked, when, in which workflow, and the question	The starting point of any reconstruction
Sources retrieved	The sources considered and used, with versions and effective dates	Shows what authority the answer rested on
Answer composed	The answer delivered and the citations within it	What the user actually saw
Controls applied	Risk handling: routine, caveated or escalated, and why	Evidence that controls operated
Review	Reviewer, state, decision, comments and time	Where human accountability sits
Outcome	What was accepted, amended or rejected, and the final version	Links the record to the deliverable
Export	Who exported what, when and with which filters	Provenance of the evidence itself

Keep it minimal and sensitive-data aware. A good record captures what is needed to reconstruct a decision and no more. Questions and answers can contain sensitive information, so decisions about what to store, mask or exclude should be made with your privacy and legal teams.

SECTION 3

Review states

Evidence is not only what happened. It is the state of the answer at each point in time.

A record should show an answer's progress through a small set of review states and keep the earlier ones. The vocabulary below is illustrative. Your own may differ, but the principle holds: each transition is an event, with an actor and a time.

STATE	MEANING	TYPICAL TRANSITION
Answered	Delivered to the user with citations	To Caveated, In review or Accepted
Caveated	Delivered with prominent limits or assumptions	To In review or Accepted
Escalated	Handed to a qualified person with context	To In review
In review	A reviewer is considering it	To Accepted, Amended or Rejected
Accepted	A reviewer approved it as it stands	To Superseded if later changed
Amended	A reviewer changed it, with the change recorded	To Accepted
Rejected	A reviewer did not accept it, with a reason	Closed, or a new request
Superseded	Replaced by a later version, which is linked	Closed

Why states matter

- They show whether review took place before the answer was relied on, not merely that it did at some point.
- They make rejected and amended answers visible, which is where the useful learning sits.
- They let an auditor reconstruct the position at a given date, even if the answer later changed.

SECTION 4

Integrity, retention and access

A record is only useful if it can be trusted and found. Trust is a property of how it is kept.

The following are properties to ask about. They are described as questions because the right answer depends on your risk appetite, your obligations and your advisers, and because a vendor's claim should be tested.

PROPERTY	WHAT TO ASK
Append-only behavior	Are records added, not overwritten? Are corrections recorded as new events?
Tamper evidence	If a record were changed, would that be detectable, and by whom?
Access control	Who can see records, and are those permissions themselves recorded?
Segregation of duties	Can the person who accepted an answer also alter its record?
Retention	How long are records kept, who decides, and can the period be set by the organization?
Time reliability	Where do timestamps come from, and are they consistent across events?
Deletion and privacy	How are privacy requests reconciled with evidence retention?

The last row is a real tension. Evidence retention and privacy deletion can pull in opposite directions. Resolve it deliberately, with your privacy and legal teams, rather than by default.

SECTION 5

Evidence exports

An export is where the ledger meets the audit. It must be complete, and it must show that it is.

Auditors rarely read a ledger in place. They take an export, test it and sample from it. An export that looks complete but is not is worse than none, so completeness has to be demonstrable.

AN AUDITOR NEEDS TO...	SO THE EXPORT SHOULD PROVIDE...
Define a population	Filters by period, workflow, risk tier, reviewer and state
Know it is complete	Counts, and a statement of what was and was not included
Trace an item	Stable identifiers linking an answer to its events, sources and reviews
Read it and process it	A human-readable form and a machine-readable form
Reproduce the export	Record of who exported, when and with which filters
Sample	Clear item boundaries, so each can be selected and tested independently

THE PARTIAL-EXPORT TRAP

Be wary of any export that cannot tell you what it left out. Silent truncation, hidden filters and missing escalated items are common ways an incomplete record passes for a complete one.

SECTION 6

How audit teams use the ledger

Four uses, each testing a different part of the control environment over AI-assisted work.

AUDIT OBJECTIVE	WHAT THE LEDGER LETS YOU DO
Test controls	Check that higher-risk matters were escalated and reviewed as the policy requires
Reconstruct a decision	Follow one answer from request to outcome, including sources and reviewer
Evaluate reviewers	Compare acceptance, amendment and rejection patterns across reviewers
Investigate an incident	Establish what happened, what should have caught it and what changed afterwards

A simple procedure

- **Understand the workflow.** What AI assists, who relies on it, and where it feeds a deliverable.
- **Identify the key controls.** For example, escalation of high-risk matters, and review before reliance.
- **Define the population.** Use the export filters, and confirm completeness.
- **Select a sample.** Include high-risk, escalated and rejected items, not only routine ones.
- **Reconstruct each item.** Check the sources, the handling and the review against policy.
- **Evaluate and report.** Note exceptions, and whether they point to a control, a reviewer or a system issue.

The procedure is deliberately ordinary. Evidence that fits the audit methods your team already uses is far more valuable than evidence that requires inventing new ones.

SECTION 7

A worked example: reconstructing one answer

What an auditor actually does with a record, step by step. The example is generic and illustrative.

Suppose an audit team selects one AI-assisted answer from a sample because the matter was escalated. They have only the record and the export. The table shows what they would look for at each event.

EVENT	WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	WHAT THE AUDITOR CHECKS
Request	A named user, in a defined workflow, asked a question on a given date	Was the user entitled to use this workflow?
Sources retrieved	Two approved sources, with versions and effective dates	Were they the right sources and the right versions for the period?
Answer composed	An answer with citations to those sources	Does each citation support its claim?
Controls applied	Handled as high-risk and escalated, with the reason	Did the control operate as the policy requires?
Review	A senior reviewer picked it up and recorded a decision and a comment	Was the reviewer authorized, and was review timely?
Outcome	The answer was amended, with the change recorded and linked	Does the final version match what was relied on?
Export	The export names who produced it, when and with which filters	Is the export itself trustworthy?

Three things stand out. First, the auditor never needs the original conversation. Second, every check is answerable from the record. Third, a gap at any step, such as a missing version or an unrecorded reviewer, is itself a finding: it tells the team where the evidence breaks down.

PRACTICE THIS BEFORE YOU NEED IT

Run this reconstruction on a real pilot item before you rely on the system. If an auditor cannot complete it from the record alone, the record is not yet evidence.

SECTION 8

An evidence-readiness checklist

Twelve questions to put to any vendor, and to your own organization, before relying on AI-assisted work.

QUESTION	WHY IT MATTERS
Does every AI-assisted answer produce a record, including escalations and rejections?	Completeness
Are sources identified with versions and effective dates?	Provenance and currency
Are the risk handling and its reason recorded?	Shows controls operated
Are reviewer, decision and time recorded for each state change?	Human accountability
Are earlier states preserved after an answer is amended?	Reconstruction at a point in time
Are corrections recorded as new events?	Append-only behavior
Can alteration be detected?	Integrity
Who can see records, and is access itself recorded?	Confidentiality and oversight
Who sets retention, and how are privacy requests reconciled?	Obligations in tension
Can an auditor export a defined population?	Audit usability
Does the export show what was and was not included?	Completeness evidence
Is the export itself recorded?	Provenance of the evidence

For security, privacy and technical-interface questions, use the owning pages rather than a vendor summary. Section 9 lists them.

SECTION 9

Where ZoikoLogia™ fits

We built ZoikoLogia™ with Kriton™ around these ideas. You should hold us to the same checks as everyone else.

ZoikoLogia™ with Kriton™ is a governed AI accounting intelligence platform. Its design intent is that what the advisor relied on can be reviewed afterwards: governed, source-backed and auditable, with answers tied to approved sources, risk handling that runs through to escalation, and qualified people who stay accountable.

What evidence is recorded and exported in your deployment, and how, is something to verify against your own audit requirements, not to assume from a description. The checklist in Section 8 applies to us as it does to anyone, and current evidence and its status are on the Trust pages.

We would rather you verify than trust. Evidence stays with the pages that own it, and each page states what is currently published and what is not:

IF YOU WANT TO CHECK	WHERE TO LOOK
How the organization is governed	Governance
Compliance information and its status	Compliance
How data is protected	Privacy & Security
Provider evaluation and questionnaires	Provider Due Diligence
Accessibility	Accessibility
Documented technical interfaces	API Reference
Recent product changes	Release Notes
Where to start	Trust

WHAT THIS PAPER DOES NOT CLAIM

It does not claim any certification, attestation or compliance status. It makes no statement about pricing, availability or outcomes for your organization, and it provides no accounting, tax, legal, audit or compliance advice. Current evidence and its status are on the Trust pages.

SECTION 10

Next step: test evidence readiness against your audit needs

The most informative test is whether your own auditors can reconstruct a decision from the record.

This is an Enterprise Access paper, and the most useful next step is a conversation about your own requirements. Bring the checklist, the questions your auditors ask and an example of a decision you would need to reconstruct.

Request Enterprise Briefing

The recommended next step. A governance-focused conversation for audit, risk, finance and AI governance stakeholders.

Book a Demo

A guided walkthrough of the product.

Request Pilot

A controlled evaluation of one defined workflow.

Trust

Evidence and specialist pages, with their current status.

Find each on the ZoikoLogia™ website. A submission through any of them does not confirm pricing, availability, response timing or commercial terms.

What to bring to the conversation

BRING	WHY IT HELPS
Your audit and retention requirements	The standard against which the record is judged
Three decisions you would need to reconstruct	A concrete test of the record
The checklist in Section 8, with your priorities	Shows where you need the most assurance
Your privacy and legal contacts	Retention and privacy must be resolved together
Your internal audit or assurance lead	They decide whether the evidence is usable

APPENDIX A

Glossary

TERM	MEANING IN THIS PAPER
Evidence ledger	A structured, ordered record of how an AI-assisted answer was produced, reviewed and used.
Event	A recorded occurrence with a time, an actor and details, such as a request or a review decision.
Review state	The position of an answer in review, such as answered, in review, accepted or amended.
Provenance	The origin of an answer: its sources, versions and handling.
Append-only	A record is added to, and corrections are new entries rather than overwrites.
Tamper evidence	The ability to detect that a record has been altered.
Segregation of duties	Separating roles so one person cannot both approve and alter the record of an approval.
Population	The set of items from which an audit sample is drawn.
Completeness indicator	Information showing what an export includes and excludes.

APPENDIX B

Important information

This paper is educational research. It does not constitute accounting, tax, legal, audit or compliance advice, and professional decisions must remain subject to qualified human review and applicable rules. The tiers, tables, checklists and scorecards are illustrative frameworks to support your own evaluation, not statements about the performance of any product. Statements about ZoikoLogia™ describe its design intent and are not guarantees of outcomes. Verify current status on the relevant pages of the ZoikoLogia™ website.

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